

VPA IGCSE ICT Year 10 Semester 2 — Weeks 10–18 Mock Exams & Final Prep

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Victoria Park Academy | IGCSE ICT (0417) | Weeks 10 – 18

This block focuses on full mock examinations under timed conditions, detailed feedback and gap analysis, and targeted final preparation to ensure every student enters Year 11 with confidence and a clear improvement plan.

Overview: Mock Examination Structure

Paper	Content	Duration	Marks	Weighting
Paper 1	Theory — Written examination covering all syllabus topics	2 hours	100 marks	40% of final grade
Paper 2	Document Production, Data Manipulation, Presentations — Practical examination	2 hours 30 minutes	80 marks	30% of final grade
Paper 3	Web Authoring, Databases — Practical examination	2 hours	80 marks	30% of final grade

Week 10 — Mock Paper 1 (Theory) Part A

☐ Mock Paper 1 — Theory Examination

Duration: 2 hours | Conditions: Examination conditions (silent, no notes, no devices)

Format: This mock uses an authentic past paper or teacher-generated paper matching IGCSE 0417 Paper 1 style.

Section Breakdown:

Section A (30 marks): Short-answer questions (1–3 marks each) covering hardware, software, networks, security

Section B (30 marks): Medium-answer questions (4–6 marks each) covering data analysis, databases, programming concepts

Section C (40 marks): Extended-response questions (8–12 marks each) covering digital citizenship, systems analysis, emerging technologies

Pre-Exam Preparation:

Revision session: 1 hour on Monday reviewing key theory topics

Flashcard review: Students self-test using digital flashcards (Quizlet/Anki)

Mind map challenge: Create a mind map of the entire syllabus in 20 minutes

Week 11 — Mock Paper 1 Feedback & Targeted Revision

☐ Mock Paper 1 Feedback & Analysis

Lesson 1: Mark Scheme Review (90 minutes)

Teacher walks through the mark scheme question by question

Students mark their own papers using the official mark scheme (different coloured pen)

Common errors are highlighted and discussed as a class

Key terminology gaps are identified

Lesson 2: Personal Gap Analysis (90 minutes)

Students complete a personal error analysis sheet:

Question	Marks Lost	Reason	Syllabus Topic	Action
Q3	2	Didn't define 'latency' precisely	Networks	Revise network terminology flashcards
Q7	3	Missed ethical dimension	Digital Citizenship	Practice PEEL paragraphs for ethics questions
Q12	4	Confused normalisation levels	Databases	Redo normalisation exercises from textbook

Lesson 3: Targeted Revision (90 minutes)

Students work on their weakest topic areas using differentiated resources

Bronze: Scaffolded worksheets with worked examples

Silver: Past paper questions with mark scheme access

Gold: Extension questions and peer teaching opportunities

Week 12 — Mock Paper 2 (Document Production) Part A

☐ Mock Paper 2 — Document Production Practical

Duration: 2 hours 30 minutes | Conditions: Practical examination conditions (individual work, no internet, no templates)

Format: Students receive a scenario and source files. They must produce:

Task 1 (30 marks): A fully formatted document (letter, report, or newsletter) with styles, tables, images, and mail merge

Task 2 (30 marks): A spreadsheet with formulas, functions, charts, and conditional formatting

Task 3 (20 marks): A presentation with appropriate design, transitions, and animations

Pre-Exam Preparation:

Speed drill: Complete a basic document formatting task in 15 minutes

Formula check: Rapid-fire formula writing (10 formulas in 10 minutes)

Presentation sprint: Create a 3-slide presentation in 10 minutes

Week 13 — Mock Paper 2 Feedback & Targeted Revision

☐ Mock Paper 2 Feedback & Analysis

Lesson 1: Live Marking Demonstration (90 minutes)

Teacher projects an anonymous student response and marks it live

Class discusses why marks were awarded or withheld

Focus on common errors: missing mail merge fields, incorrect cell references, inconsistent formatting

Lesson 2: Peer Assessment Workshop (90 minutes)

Students swap digital files and assess using the mark scheme

Peer assessment checklist:

Task	Check	Marks
Document	☐ Styles applied consistently? ☐ Mail merge works? ☐ Table formatted? ☐ Images positioned?	/30
Spreadsheet	☐ Formulas correct? ☐ Charts labelled? ☐ Conditional formatting? ☐ Cell protection?	/30
Presentation	☐ Master slide used? ☐ Transitions appropriate? ☐ Animations enhance? ☐ Speaker notes?	/20

Lesson 3: Technique Refinement (90 minutes)

Speed techniques: Keyboard shortcuts, quick styles, auto-fill

Error prevention: Checklists for each task type

Time management: Practise completing Task 1 in 60 minutes, Task 2 in 60 minutes, Task 3 in 30 minutes

Week 14 — Mock Paper 3 (Web & Database) Part A

☐ Mock Paper 3 — Web Authoring & Databases Practical

Duration: 2 hours | Conditions: Practical examination conditions (individual work, no internet, no pre-built templates)

Format: Students receive a scenario and source files. They must produce:

Task 1 (40 marks): A multi-page website with HTML, CSS, navigation, forms, and embedded media

Task 2 (40 marks): A relational database with tables, relationships, queries, forms, and reports

Pre-Exam Preparation:

HTML/CSS speed test: Build a basic 3-page site in 30 minutes

SQL drill: Write 5 common queries in 10 minutes (SELECT, WHERE, ORDER BY, JOIN, aggregate)

Database design challenge: Design a 3-table database with relationships in 15 minutes

Week 15 — Mock Paper 3 Feedback & Targeted Revision

☐ Mock Paper 3 Feedback & Analysis

Lesson 1: Code Review Session (90 minutes)

Teacher displays exemplary HTML/CSS code and discusses best practices

Common HTML errors: missing closing tags, incorrect nesting, missing alt attributes

Common CSS errors: missing semicolons, incorrect selectors, unclosed braces

Common SQL errors: incorrect JOIN syntax, missing GROUP BY, wrong aggregate functions

Lesson 2: Debugging Workshop (90 minutes)

Students are given "broken" HTML pages and must fix them

Students are given "broken" SQL queries and must correct them

Use W3C validator to check HTML; test queries against expected output

Lesson 3: HTML/CSS & SQL Refinement (90 minutes)

Responsive design practice: Make a page mobile-friendly in 15 minutes

Complex query practice: Write queries with multiple JOINS and subqueries

Form validation: Add HTML5 validation attributes to a form

Week 16 — Gap Analysis & Personalised Revision

☐ Comprehensive Gap Analysis

Individual Progress Tracking:

Student	P1 Score	P2 Score	P3 Score	Total	Grade	Priority Areas
Student A	62/100	58/80	55/80	175/260	B	Theory: Networks; P2: Formulas; P3: SQL JOINS
Student B	78/100	72/80	68/80	218/260	A	P3: Responsive CSS; P1: Extended responses
Student C	45/100	38/80	42/80	125/260	D	All areas — intensive support required

Differentiated Intervention Groups:

Intensive Support (Grade D/E): Daily 30-minute sessions focusing on core skills. Priority: document formatting, basic formulas, simple HTML, SELECT queries.

Targeted Support (Grade C): 3 sessions per week on identified weak areas. Priority: mail merge, VLOOKUP, CSS positioning, database relationships.

Extension (Grade A/A*): Advanced challenges: JavaScript interactivity, complex SQL with subqueries, CSS animations, examination technique refinement.

Week 17 — Final Examination Technique

☐ Examination Technique Mastery

Paper 1 Technique:

Time allocation: 1 mark $\approx$ 1.2 minutes. A 3-mark question = 3–4 minutes. A 12-mark question = 14–15 minutes.

Command words: "State" = 1 sentence; "Describe" = 2–3 sentences with detail; "Explain" = cause and effect; "Evaluate" = pros, cons, and judgment.

Extended responses: Use PEEL structure (Point, Evidence, Explanation, Link) for 8+ mark questions.

Diagrams: Always draw diagrams when asked — a well-labelled diagram can earn 3–4 marks instantly.

Don't leave blanks: Even a partial answer can earn 1 mark. Write something relevant.

Paper 2 Technique:

File management: Save frequently (Ctrl+S every 5 minutes). Save with correct filenames as specified.

Task order: Start with your strongest task to build confidence and secure marks early.

Evidence document: Take screenshots of key steps (formulas, mail merge results, chart settings) as evidence.

Check, check, check: In the last 10 minutes, verify: all files saved, all tasks complete, no placeholder text remaining.

Paper 3 Technique:

HTML validation: Test your pages in a browser constantly. Check links work. Check images display.

CSS testing: Resize the browser window to test responsiveness. Check colours and fonts are consistent.

Database testing: Run every query and verify the output matches expectations. Test with edge cases (empty fields, duplicate data).

Backup: Keep a copy of your original source files in a separate folder before you start modifying.

Time Management Drills:

Monday: Paper 1 speed drill — 20 questions in 25 minutes

Tuesday: Paper 2 Task 1 speed drill — complete document in 50 minutes

Wednesday: Paper 2 Task 2 speed drill — complete spreadsheet in 50 minutes

Thursday: Paper 3 Task 1 speed drill — build 2-page site in 45 minutes

Friday: Paper 3 Task 2 speed drill — build database with 3 queries in 45 minutes

Week 18 — Final Preparation & Confidence Building

☐ Final Week: Confidence & Readiness

Monday: Light Revision (60 minutes)

Review one-page summary notes for each paper

Quick-fire terminology test (50 terms in 20 minutes)

Watch "examination technique" video reminders

Tuesday: Peer Teaching (60 minutes)

Students teach each other their strongest topic in 5-minute micro-lessons

Gold students support Bronze students in targeted areas

Create a class "examination tips" poster

Wednesday: Mock Examination Reflection (60 minutes)

Students write a letter to their future self (start of Year 11) with advice

Class discussion: "What I learned from mocks that will help me succeed"

Celebration of progress: Compare diagnostic test (Week 1) with mock results

Thursday: Stress Management & Wellbeing (60 minutes)

Mindfulness and breathing exercises for examination anxiety

Physical preparation: sleep, nutrition, hydration advice

Examination day checklist: what to bring, what to do, what to avoid

Friday: Final Confidence Activity (60 minutes)

"Examination Ready" pledge: Each student signs a commitment to their preparation plan

Teacher distributes personalised "strengths cards" — one thing each student does excellently

Class photo and celebration of the semester's hard work

Examination Day Checklist

Before the Exam	During the Exam	After the Exam
☐ Sleep 8+ hours ☐ Eat a balanced breakfast ☐ Arrive 15 minutes early ☐ Bring: pen, pencil, ruler, eraser, calculator (if allowed) ☐ Bring: student ID, examination timetable ☐ Visit the bathroom before entering ☐ Take 3 deep breaths	☐ Read all instructions carefully ☐ Check the number of questions ☐ Allocate time per question ☐ Start with confident questions ☐ Show all working ☐ Save files frequently (P2/P3) ☐ Check filenames match requirements ☐ Use remaining time to review	☐ Don't discuss answers immediately ☐ Focus on next examination ☐ Note any topics to revise ☐ Reward yourself for effort ☐ Get rest before next exam

Gap Analysis Template for Students

Student Name: _____ Date: _____

Paper	Score	Target	Gap	Actions to Close Gap	Resources	Deadline
Paper 1	___/100	___/100				
Paper 2	___/80	___/80				
Paper 3	___/80	___/80				

Teacher Signature: _____ Student Signature: _____

差距分析模板：学生填写每份模拟试卷的分数、目标分数、差距、改进措施、资源和截止日期。教师和学生双方签字确认，确保责任明确。

Teacher Note: All mock papers should be stored securely and not returned to students until after the feedback session. This prevents answer sharing between groups. Consider creating 2-3 versions of each mock paper for students who were absent or need a retake.

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